18.1 select_all

`find_by_sql` has a close relative called `connection#select_all`. `select_all` will retrieve objects from the database using custom SQL just like `find_by_sql` but will not instantiate them. Instead, you will get an array of hashes where each hash indicates a record.

```
Client.connection.select_all("SELECT first_name, created_at FROM
clients WHERE id = '1'")
# => [
  {"first_name"=>"Rafael", "created_at"=>"2012-11-10
23:23:45.281189"},
  {"first_name"=>"Eileen", "created_at"=>"2013-12-09 11:22:35.221282"}
]
```

18.2 pluck

`pluck` can be used to query single or multiple columns from the underlying table of a model. It accepts a list of column names as argument and returns an array of values of the specified columns with the corresponding data type.

```
Client.where(active: true).pluck(:id)
# SELECT id FROM clients WHERE active = 1
# => [1, 2, 3]

Client.distinct.pluck(:role)
# SELECT DISTINCT role FROM clients
# => ['admin', 'member', 'guest']

Client.pluck(:id, :name)
# SELECT clients.id, clients.name FROM clients
# => [[1, 'David'], [2, 'Jeremy'], [3, 'Jose']]
```

`pluck` makes it possible to replace code like:

```
Client.select(:id).map { |c| c.id }
# or
Client.select(:id).map(&:id)
# or
Client.select(:id, :name).map { |c| [c.id, c.name] }
```

with:

```
Client.pluck(:id)
# or
Client.pluck(:id, :name)
```

Unlike `select`, `pluck` directly converts a database result into a Ruby `Array`, without constructing `ActiveRecord` objects. This can mean better performance for a large or often-running query. However, any model method overrides will not be available. For example:

```
class Client < ActiveRecord::Base
  def name
    "I am #{super}"
  end
end

Client.select(:name).map &:name
# => ["I am David", "I am Jeremy", "I am Jose"]

Client.pluck(:name)
# => ["David", "Jeremy", "Jose"]
```

Furthermore, unlike `select` and other `Relation` scopes, `pluck` triggers an immediate query, and thus cannot be chained with any further scopes, although it can work with scopes already constructed earlier:

```
Client.pluck(:name).limit(1)
# => NoMethodError: undefined method `limit' for
#<Array:0x007ff34d3ad6d8>

Client.limit(1).pluck(:name)
# => ["David"]
```